

CUNY AI LAB

Configuring skills and tools

New Media Lab · Room 7388.01
CUNY Graduate Center

Thursday, October 15, 2026 · 2:30–4:00 p.m. Eastern

Developed by Zach Muhlbauer

https://cuny-ai-lab.github.io/sandbox-series/skills

Choose Your Own Adventure

Continue your saved model or clone it first

Open **Workspace → Models → Edit**
Read your actual system prompt
Identify setting, goals, and rules

Keep this model card open while you add a skill and a tool

What Is a Skill?

Skills contain plain-text instructions for repeatable tasks

Trigger	Request or condition that starts a procedure
Procedure	Steps, checks, and points that require a question
Output	Required response content and form

Skill Examples

Workspace → Skills · 1 of 3

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

History Of Ideas Abstract Critique /history-of-ideas-abstract-critique 3 days ago

Guide revision of relationships among ideas and their implications.

Historical Context Abstract Critique /historical-context-abstract-critique 3 days ago

Guide revision of historical conditions as drivers of intellectual change.

Extend STEM Adventures /extend-stem-adventures a month ago

Add a source-based experimental procedure to STEM Adventure, or examine a submitted play record.

ChartJS Visualization /chartjs-visualization 2 months ago

Use whenever a request would benefit from plotting quantitative data or mathematical relationships, even when the user ...

Skill Examples

Workspace → Skills · 2 of 3

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

Response Features /response-features 5 months ago

Error Handling /error-handling 5 months ago

Language Adjustment /language-adjustment- 5 months ago

Writing-Support-Opener /writing-support-opener 6 months ago

Open every interaction with one brief, humanizing question unrelated to the assignment

Skill Examples

Workspace → Skills · 3 of 3

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

Conversational Etiquette /conversational-etiquette 6 months ago

Supports short, turn-taking dialogue as a prose-first, anti-slop corrective

Native Orthography /preserve-native-orthography 6 months ago

Preserves correct native spelling, scripts, diacritics, and punctuation across languages.

One-Step Dialogue /adaptive_conversational_scaffolding_v1 6 months ago

Pedagogical scaffolding for inquisitive dialogue following a one-step extension + question per turn

Add Your Skill

In **Workspace → Models → Edit**, find **Skills → Select Skill**

Choose existing **Extend Adventure Games**

Read its saved instructions
Keep this model card open for Adventure Kit

What Is a Tool?

When a model calls a **tool**, Sandbox executes a function and returns its result

Tool calling, otherwise known as **function calling**, sends a function name and arguments for execution

Input	Arguments supplied to a function
Execution	Code that applies specified rules
Result	Returned output for a model to inspect

Tool Examples

Workspace → Tools · 1 of 4

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

Adventure Kit v2.0.0 8 hours ago

Create participant-defined choice adventures with configurable state, rules and endings. No built-in scenario.

Chat Export v0.3.1 21 hours ago

Saves chat content (headings, text, lists and tables) as a downloadable Word (.docx) or PDF file, plus Markdow…

Instructor Rubric v0.4.0 21 hours ago

Checks student lab work without revealing answers. Verifies ONE calculation per lab part, flags data that break…

Tool Examples

Workspace → Tools · 2 of 4

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

OCR reader v0.2.0 2 days ago

reads scanned or image-only PDFs (and images) that come up blank. Runs OCR on pages with no text layer and...

Instructional Toolset v0.6.0 3 days ago

Deterministically lists and loads curriculum units for instructional AI models.

Pronunciation and Translation Tool ✨ v5.1.1 3 days ago

https://openwebui.com/posts/pronunciation_and_translation_tool_d8a83bca

Tool Examples

Workspace → Tools · 3 of 4

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

Graphing v0.1.0 a month ago

Graphing tool

PhysicsPY v0.4.0 2 months ago

Source-grounded physics laboratory analysis with static SVG charts.

ChartJS v2.0.0 2 months ago

Charts is a tool for the Sandbox that renders chart elements in-chat using an HTML5 canvas via Chart.js cdn

Charts (v1) v1.3.0 2 months ago

Charts is a tool for OpenWebUI that allows you to create charts using the Chart.js cdn

Tool Examples

Workspace → Tools · 4 of 4

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

Preflight Student Input 3 months ago

Solicits input from students before commencing an exercise or assignment

Kale GitHub v0.1.0 5 months ago

Checks recent activity across CUNY AI Lab's GitHub org

Whisper CUDA v0.7.0 a year ago

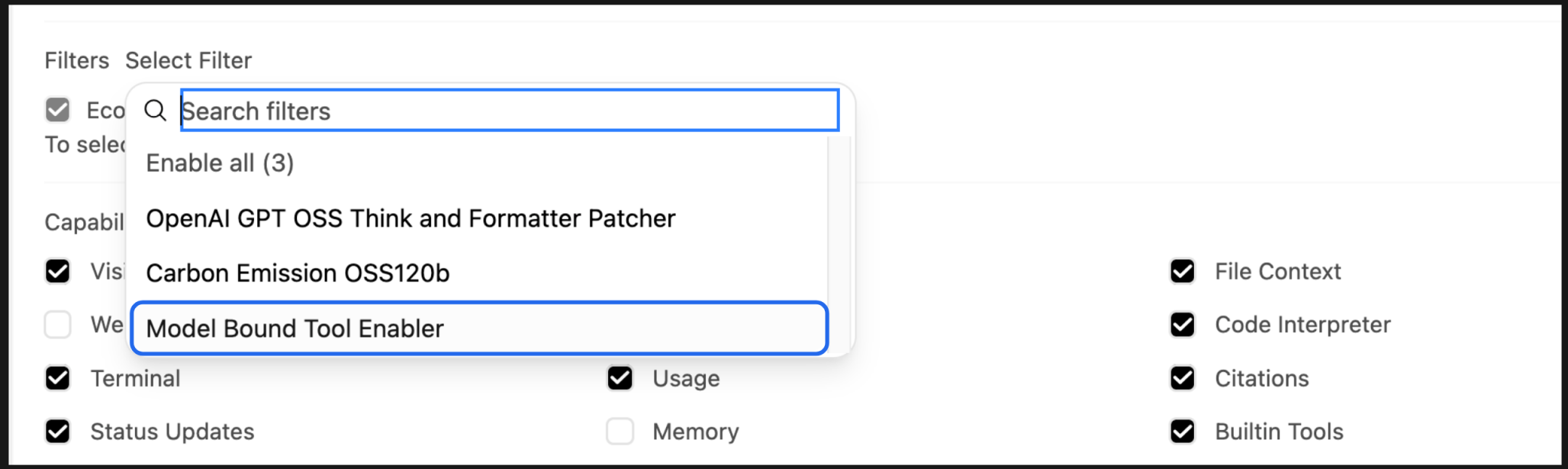
Whisper Cuda

cloudflare_whisper_tool v0.6.0 a year ago

cloudflare_whisper_tool

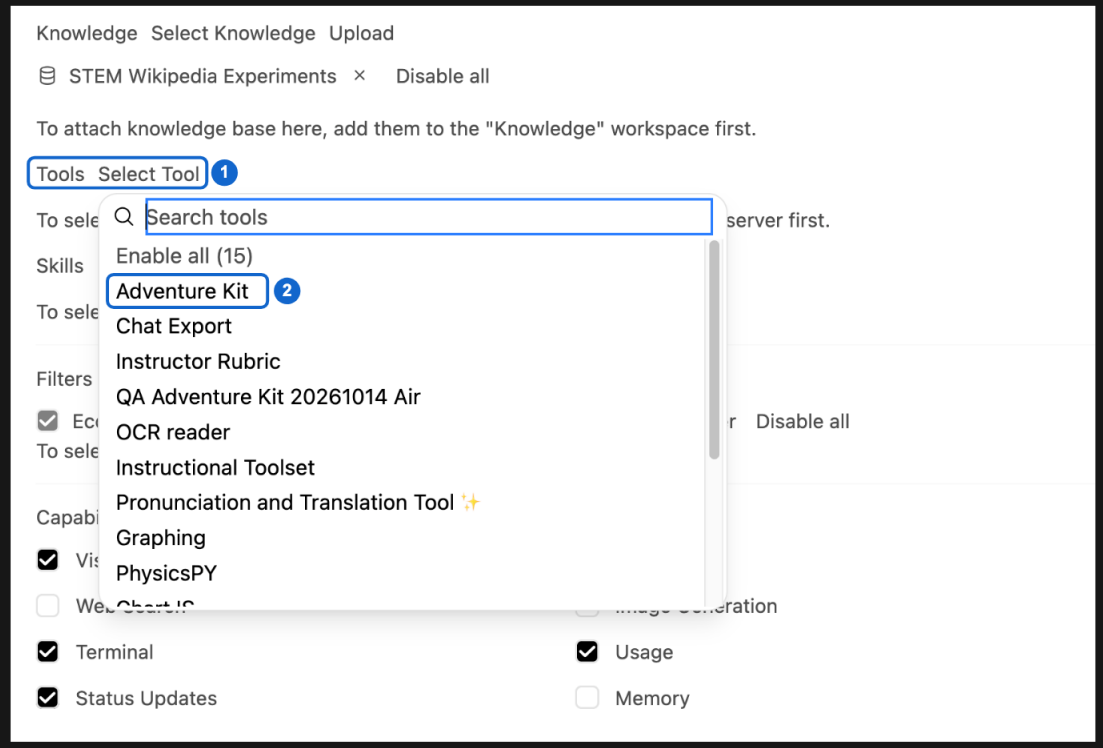
Enable Filter

Enable **Model Bound Tool Enabler** on your model card.
Why: It restores attached tools when a chat omits them.

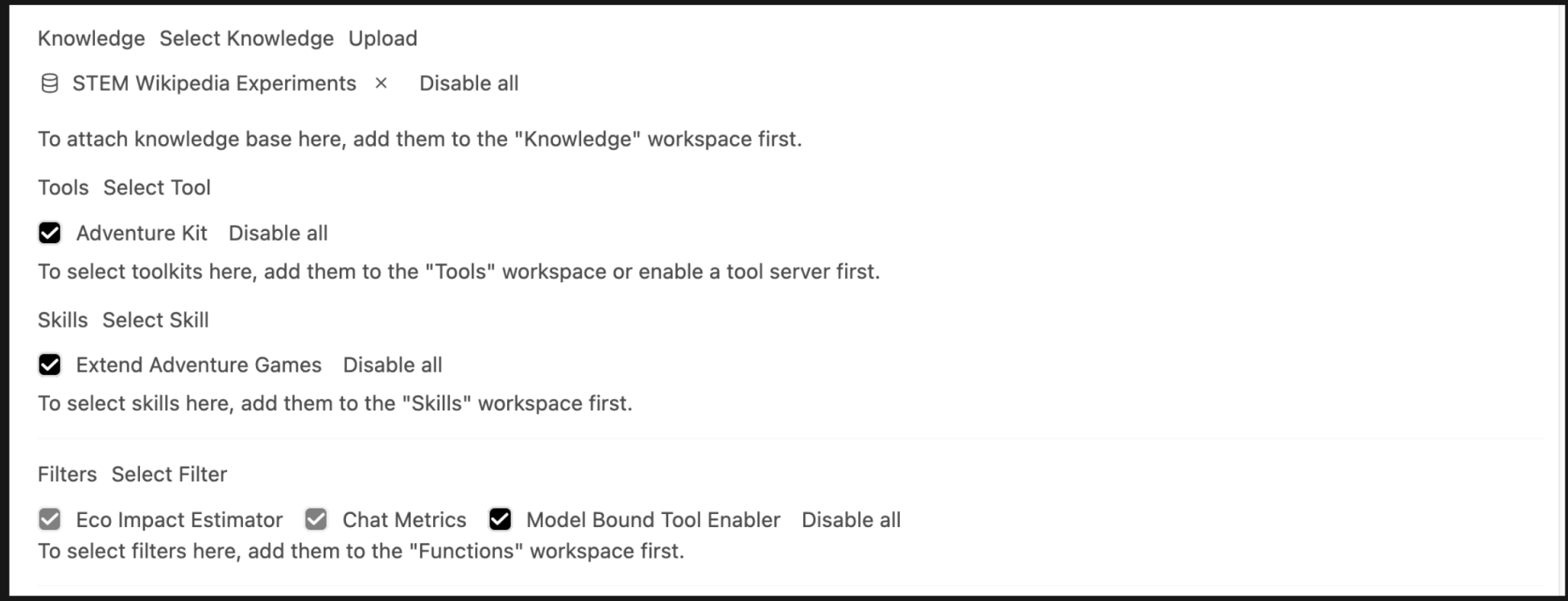


Add the ‘Adventure Kit’ tool

In this same model card, open **Tools → Select Tool**
Choose **Adventure Kit** · Confirm **Extend Adventure Games** remains selected
Add next prompt instruction, then click **Save & Update** before testing



Ensure that your model card has a knowledge collection, tool, skill, and filter configured like the image below.



Add Skill Instructions

Copy prompt

Load the extend_adventure_games skill and follow it on every turn, calling the adventure_kit tool only as the skill directs. Use no other skills or tools.

Test Your Adventure

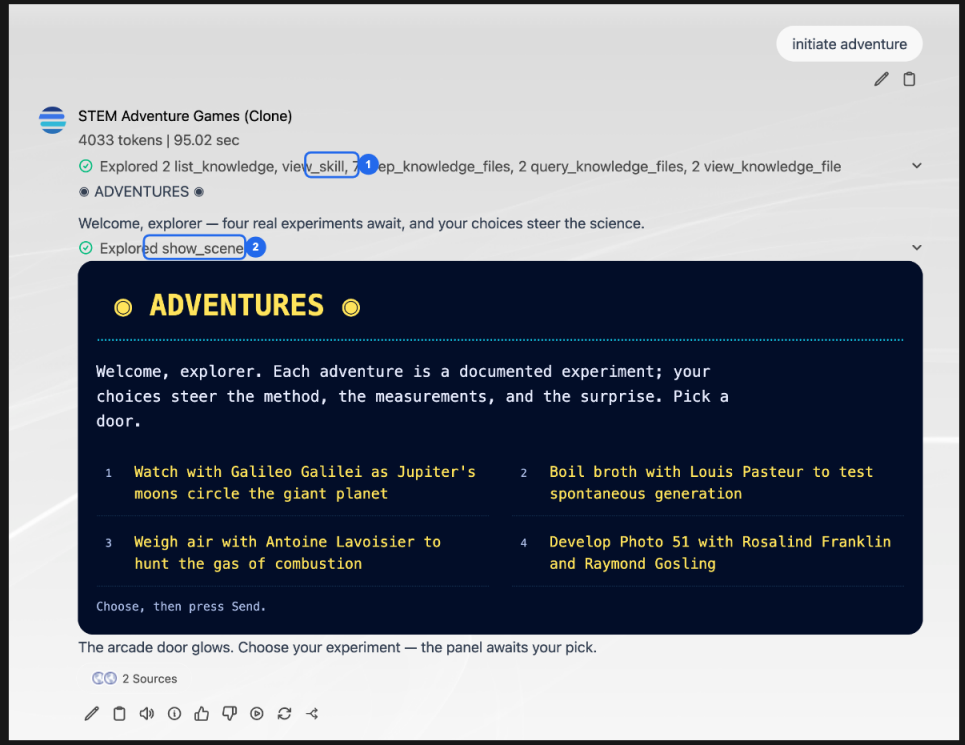
Run your updated adventure game

Verify configured skill and tool are called appropriately

Then play the rest of your game

Observe Game Results

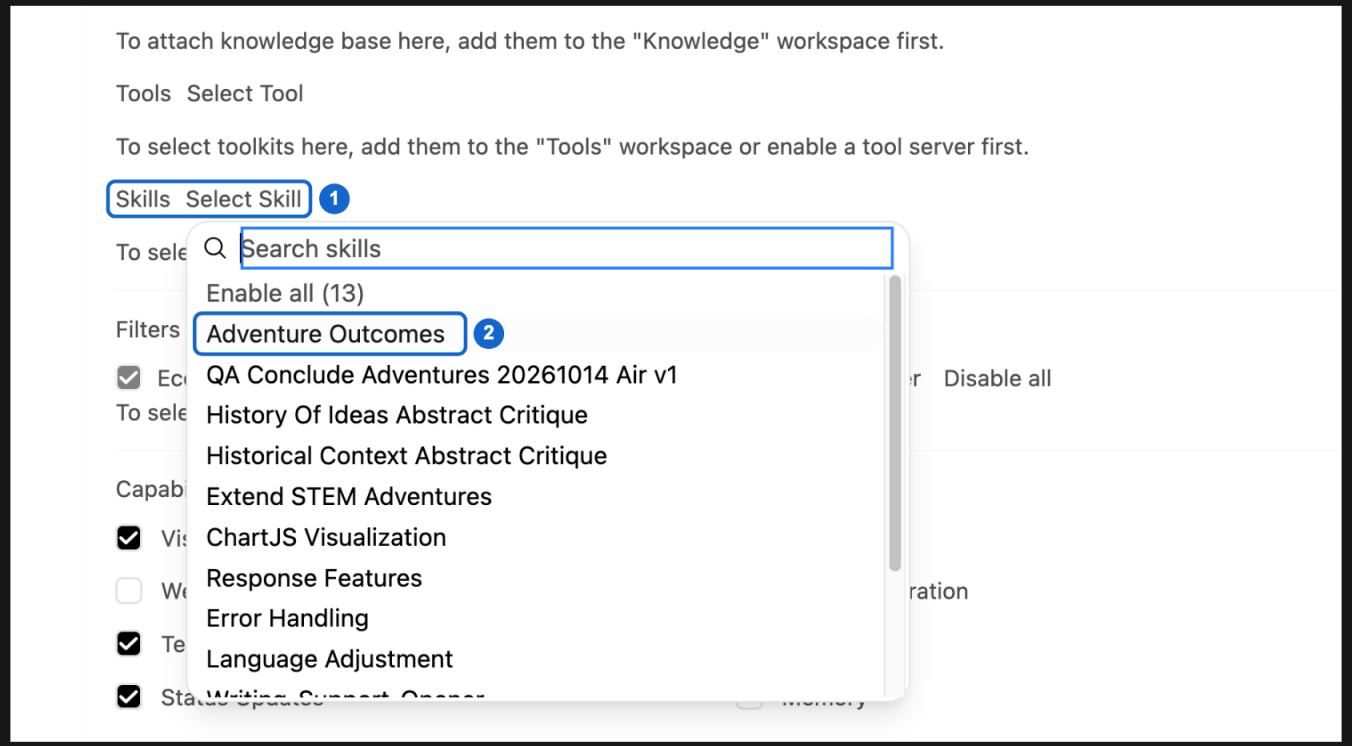
① Check skill call · ② Check tool call
Open details to confirm selected skill



Explore Other Skills

After your first adventure works, try **Adventure Outcomes** or **Conclude Adventures** if available

Read saved instructions · Change one item · Save your model card and compare results



Choose Your Task

Revise One Item

Copy complete tool code or skill instructions

Describe an observed problem and one change

Copy tool code · Skill instructions

Create Your Own

Choose your own tool or skill

Specify purpose, required input, and expected result

Work With Support

Open **CAIL Workspace Support**
Paste original content or your new task, system prompt, and required sources
Request complete content, an explanation, and one test · Copy request



Adapt Your Adventure

Bring a lesson outcome, weekly concept, and current adventure to **CAIL Workspace Support**

Ask it to revise your orchestration skill or tool, or design a new one
Supply complete content, system prompt, scenario, and play record

Review proposed changes before running them · Copy Support request

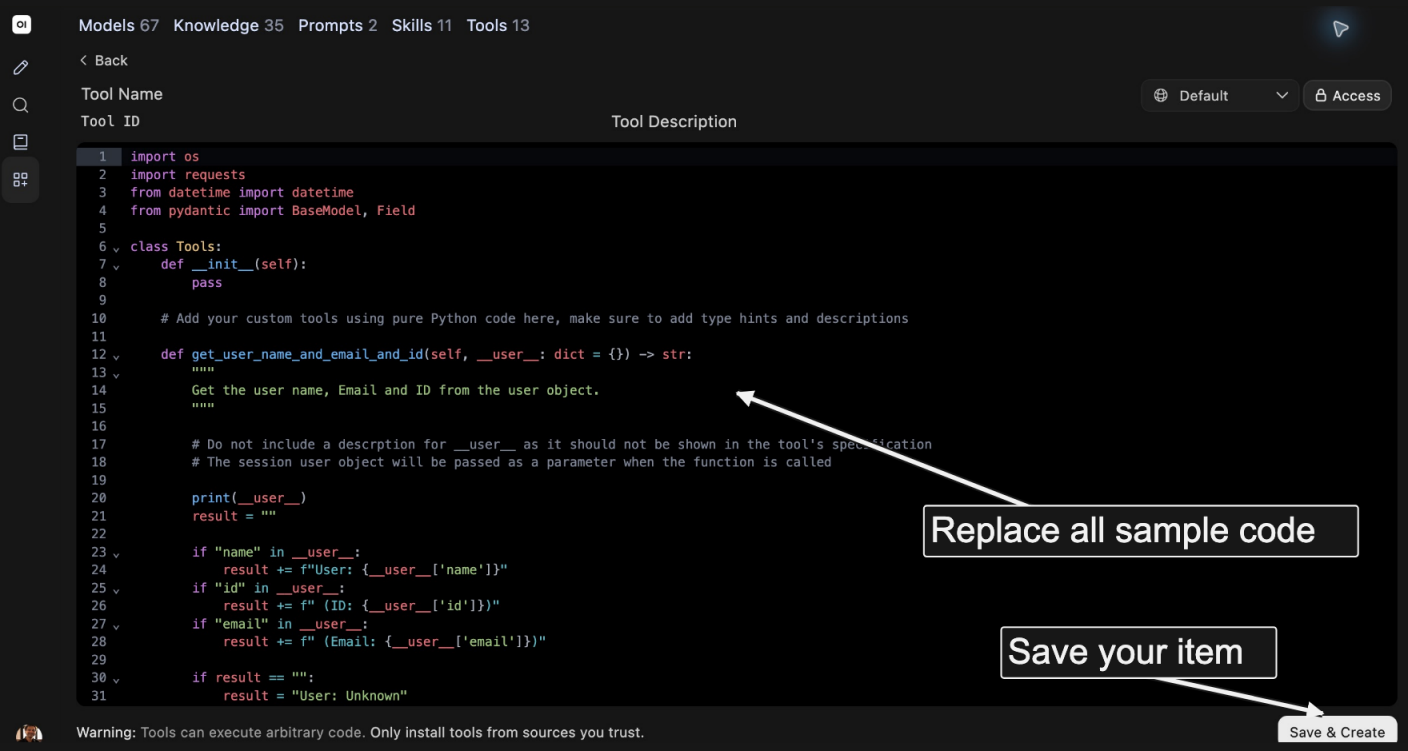
Add Tools or Skills

Create a new **tool** or **skill**, or save a revised copy

Use **Workspace → Tools → Create** or **Skills → Create**

Enter new Name and ID; paste complete reviewed content

Review **Access**, then **Save & Create** · Select and test your item



Series Reflections

What task in your teaching or research could benefit from a skill or tool?

Would you be interested in joining our coworking session on October 29, 2–4pm, to build your adventure into a collection so that we can showcase our work over the course of the series?

What would you develop next with the prompts, knowledge collections, skills, and tools you have explored?